

You are being invited to take part in a research study to further our understanding of how we engage with imagination. Thank you for carefully reading this information sheet. This study is being conducted by Kevin Sheldrake and Prof Zoltan Dienes from the School of Psychology, University of Sussex, who are happy to be contacted (K.Sheldrake@sussex.ac.uk or dienes@sussex.ac.uk) if you

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Date: 5/4/2024

Version: 4

have any questions. This research has been approved (ER/KS719/2) by the Sciences & Technology Cross-Schools Research Ethics Committee (C-REC) (crecscitec@sussex.ac.uk). The University of Sussex has insurance in place to cover its legal liabilities in respect of this study.

Why have I been invited to take part and what will I do?

We are testing about 12 people. The test will take **one hour** using Zoom on a University account. The Zoom meeting will be recorded for analysis. You will be asked to imagine various simple behaviours and sensations, such as your hands being pulled together like magnets, and to reflect on the experiences. There will be three such imaginative exercises plus a warm up exercise. You will rate how strongly you experienced various sensations, such as your hands being pulled together, and will be asked questions about your experiences.

Do I have to take part?

It is up to you to decide whether or not to take part. If you do decide to take part you can keep a copy of this information sheet. If you decide to take part you are still free to withdraw at any time and without giving a reason.

What will happen to the results and my personal information?

The research may be written into a scientific report for publication. We anticipate being able to provide a summary of our findings on request from October 2024 (K.Sheldrake@sussex.ac.uk or dienes@sussex.ac.uk). The privacy of your data will be ensured; it will be stored on a university managed system and will only be accessible by the experimenters. If you have completed a PCS exercise in Cognition in Clinical Contexts and consented to your score being in the database, then we will include your score in the analysis and report. The analysis of the data and the resultant report will not personally identify any experiment participants. Please read this information carefully and then, if you wish to take part, signing up for a time slot on SONA shows *you have fully understood this sheet, and that you consent to take part in the study as it is described here.*

CONSENT

- I understand that I am agreeing to take part in the University of Sussex research described here, and that I have read and understood this information sheet.
- I understand that my participation is entirely voluntary, that I can choose not to participate in part or all of the study, and that I can withdraw at any stage without having to give a reason and without being penalised in any way (e.g., if I am a student, my decision whether or not to take part will not affect my grades).
- I understand that the researchers will be able to see me on Zoom. Data collected during the Zoom study will be identified by my name and may be linked to my Phenomenal Control Scale (PCS) score (should I have completed a PCS exercise in Cognition in Clinical Contexts and consented to my score being in the database – ethics approvals ER/RBS20/13 [expires 10/10/2020], ER/RBS20/16 [expires 13/10/2021], ER/RBS20/17 [expires 19/10/2023], ER/RBS20/19 [expires 19/10/2024]). My data will be removed from the experiment and permanently deleted upon my request.
- I understand that my personal data will be used for the purposes of this research study and will be handled in accordance with [Data Protection legislation](#). I understand that the University's [Privacy Notice](#) provides further information on how the University uses personal data in its research.
- This research project involves the use of UoS Zoom. Details of the platform's privacy notice can be found here: [Zoom Privacy Policy](#). Electronic data will be stored securely on a university managed system. Information about data privacy can be found [here](#). Anonymised data may be made publicly available through Open Science Framework online data repository and thus may be used for research purposes by other researchers.

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- An anonymized transcript will be permanently saved to the Open Science Framework (OSF) for anyone to check the validity of the conclusions; I can request redaction of any comments I wish from that record.